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Notable quotes of 2010 from the West

Thursday, December 30, 2010

West residents, public officials, community advocates and professionals had plenty to say about a variety of news topics throughout the year.

Here are some of the interesting comments we reported in West:

January

"It's amazing how many people actually tune in."-- MCA-TV executive director **Jim Koepfinger**, on a survey that showed 85 percent of Moon residents watched the cable channel, which celebrated its 25th anniversary.

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"We want to work closely with the committees and make sure we're giving the community what it wants." -- **Craig Collins** of Axis Architecture, on the design of the planned South Fayette civic center.

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"One person called us 'small but mighty.' My face hurt from smiling so much." -- school superintendent **Donna Belas**, after receiving congratulatory e-mails for Cornell elementary school being named one of 13 in Pennsylvania nominated for a national Blue Ribbon Award.

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"It's a perfect location. We'll be able to provide more information and more community services." -- **Geri Hermann**, coordinator of the West Allegheny Food Pantry, which moved to a larger facility on Route 30 in Findlay.

February

"Among them would be the continuing increase in unemployment, which is causing more people to return to college so they can develop new skills that are attractive in the marketplace." -- **Joe D. Forrester**, president, Community College of Beaver County, giving a reason for the 7.6 percent enrollment increase.

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"Several officers said it was one of the most well-built and sophisticated ones they've seen." -- Carnegie Police Chief **Jeff Harbin**, on a homemade potato gun found in a vacant residence.

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"Our mandate as a school board is to educate all children to the best of our ability. That's what we're doing." -- Moon Area school Director **Jerry Testa** after a 3-2 vote on an extended-day kindergarten proposal.

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"We want the library to be more of a social gathering place, more relaxed, more welcoming." -- **Kim Villella**, Baden council member, on the renovated library that offers fewer books and more meeting space.

March

"We're in such a horrible dilemma right now. Are we supposed to just let these poor kids play on a playground that smells like garbage?" -- West Allegheny school Director **Anne Bolind**, on odors from Findlay's Imperial Landfill, adjacent to Wilson Elementary School.

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"It's kind of our front door, and we have to make sure our front door looks nice. If we just let it sit there as an eyesore, the

image of Oakdale isn't what it should be." -- Oakdale Councilman **Keith Merlino**, on converting an empty lot into a parklet.

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"The Carnegie Community Development Corp. is thrilled with this project. We believe the addition of a new restaurant, retail venue and personal services in the community will be a wonderful complement to the business district." -- **Leigh White**, Carnegie Community Development Corp. executive director, on plans for a cultural center at the former Holy Souls Catholic Church.

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"There is a lot of surface cracking on the runway, which has not been rehabilitated since 1990." -- **Beth C. LaValle**, director of the Beaver County Airport, on how the airport will spend a \$250,000 state grant to repair the runway.

April

"My soul aches because I will not be returning to the wonderful people at Chartiers Valley. It's home." -- **Tammy Whitfield**, former assistant Chartiers Valley superintendent, on accepting the superintendent job in Blairsville-Saltsburg.

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"A couple of months ago, we all agreed that we want transparency in government. Why do we have such a problem discussing this? -- Robinson Commissioner **Stephanie Triko-Selyo**, on the township's efforts to sort out its finances.

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"My dad went to Carnegie Elementary and I went there. There are 90 years of Kozys in those schools." -- Crafton resident **Mike Kozy Sr.**, urging the Carlynton school board not to close Crafton and Carnegie elementary schools. His children attended Crafton and his grandchildren go there.

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"If we have that kind of money on hand, why are we scrimping?" -- **Cindy Morrow**, Montour school board president, on the revelation that the district has a \$28.7 million fund balance.

May

"Wouldn't it be nice to have a trail from Monaca to Washington, D.C.?" -- **Vincent Troia**, president of the Ohio River Trail Council, on plans to develop the Monaca segment of a bike trail that would link Ohio and the nation's capital.

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"He tries to tell me what he wants done with the property. He wants housing in there, and he's not going to get housing." -- **Tom Robinson**, on Oakdale council President Ron Gamble's comments about developing the site of the former Joy Dog Food factory on Union Avenue in Oakdale. Mr. Robinson owns the property.

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"I did not anticipate this happening. I wish they would reconsider this. It's hurting a lot of folks." -- **Tim Bissert**, one of the parents disappointed about the closing of SS Simon & Jude Catholic School in Scott.

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"This is a hard thing. We gave it our best effort. We rallied. We tried." -- **Patty Paul**, one of the parents reacting to the closing of St. John of God School in Stowe.

June

"The long term is what is occurring with storm water runoff." -- Carnegie council Vice President **Pat Catina**, on resolving flooding problems in the borough after heavy rains flooded yards and basements in Lexington Court.

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"I think he has the strength we need. I think we found the right guy." -- Chartiers Valley school board President **Beth McIntyre**, on the selection of Brian White of Beaver Area School District as new superintendent.

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"It's a nice program. It's good to see young families able to afford to buy a home." -- **Tom Wiater** of Action Housing, on four single-family homes built on Grant Avenue in Heidelberg as part of a redevelopment program.

"We need to use this budget to sharpen our spear and point that spear toward Harrisburg." -- Sto-Rox school Director **Edward Maritz**, on the need for the state to increase subsidies to schools.

July

"Walmart is excited about the decision. The vote to approve our new store is reflective of their desire and the residents to have a Walmart help serve the community." -- **Jason Klipa**, senior manager for public affairs and government relations for Walmart, after Moon supervisors granted three approvals for a super center on the site of the West Hills Shopping Center.

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"These [outdoor furnaces] definitely were not made to be in a small borough like ours. But I do realize your investment too, so it's such a tough situation." -- McDonald council Vice President **Patty Phillips** on an ordinance regulating outdoor fuel-burning furnaces.

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"A contemporary aquatics complex will provide access and activities for all age groups and activity levels. The goal of this complex is to provide equal opportunities for educational, social and recreational types of program." -- Recommendation from a report on the 50-year-old Hankey Farms swimming pool in North Fayette.

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"Once we commit to it, we have to spend it. I'm confident we will be going forward with [construction], and we will be starting as soon as we possibly can." -- South Fayette school board President **William Newcomer**, on the decision to hire a firm to design a \$30 million intermediate school.

August

"They're going from bricks to clicks; we're going from clicks to bricks." -- PA Cyber Charter School director **Andrew Oberg**, on plans to open a hands-on learning center in the former Mount Gallitzin Academy in Baden.

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"A lot of fans asked if it could stay open for the rest of the summer." -- **Mary Luxbacher**, member of the Crafton library board and the municipal recreation committee, on the reopening of the miniature golf course on Steuben Street near Crafton Park.

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"It has been a long and at times exhausting process, but I'm most pleased that this chapter of our history is closed. The days of impropriety do not exist [anymore] and the current council is taking every step to see that they don't return." -- Carnegie council President **Mike Sarsfield**, on a State Ethics Commission decision banning former Carnegie Councilman Fred Carini from seeking or holding public office or public employment in Pennsylvania because of improprieties.

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"We're not going to use the 'M' word anymore -- merger." -- Central Valley superintendent **Dan Matsook**, preparing for the first day of classes for the district, which was formed from the merger of Center Area and Monaca.

September

"Mayor Linn was part of that Norman Rockwell image." -- **Tom Hamilton**, Beaver mayor, on the dedication of the post office to Robert P. Linn, who served as Beaver mayor for more than 58 years. He died in 2004 at age 95.

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"There have been a lot of improvements over the years, but now we've outgrown it. I think 85 years in one station is about enough. It's time for a new one." -- Imperial Fire Chief **Bobby Bradburn Jr.**, on plans for a new fire station in Findlay.

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"We see Miles Bryan as a viable and marketable property. We're seeking a developer with the imagination to share our vision of what is possible." -- **Taris Vrcek**, director of the McKees Rocks Development Corp., on plans to convert the former Miles Bryan school building into condominiums.

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"This consolidation is the parish's first opportunity for the kind of unity and integration that many other neighborhood churches take for granted." -- **The Rev. David Poecking**, pastor, St. Elizabeth Ann Seton, announcing plans to reopen St. Luke's Church in Carnegie as the parish's worship site.

October

"I wish nothing but the best for the residents of the Borough of Carnegie, and it has been my professional pleasure to work in this capacity." -- Former Carnegie manager **Whitney Brady** in an e-mail announcing her resignation after serving 15 months.

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"It's really been a big morale thing for our staff. We get to focus more time on instruction rather than being pulled away on construction issues." -- West Allegheny High School principal **Dan Smith**, on the conclusion of two years of renovations on his school building.

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"Please keep this out of residential areas. Think of our children and our residents and our peace of quiet, and our clean air and our clean water." -- **Diana Stoessel** of South Fayette, urging commissioners to prohibit gas and oil drilling in residential areas.

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"The number of ethnically diverse students has nearly tripled since 2005." -- **Daniel Pinchot**, director of enrollment at Penn State Beaver, on a 6 percent enrollment increase, the fifth consecutive year for growth.

November

"We want to bring some excitement and life to the plaza. We're trying to bring in new businesses and we're searching everywhere for it. I think [the Yinzers tent] will be successful and will help." -- **Sarah Piccione**, management official from the Plaza at the Pointe, on concerns that business is being lost to nearby Settler's Ridge.

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"It took me 41 years to get here." -- **Robert Barone**, who was appointed Coraopolis mayor to succeed John Haberland, who died Oct. 15. Mr. Barone had lost a mayoral election then served as a Cornell school board member and later as a council member.

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"She is a very capable individual and a good educator." -- Montour superintendent **Donald Boyer** on Fran Serenka, Sto-Rox superintendent, who was hired as Montour's special education director.

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"This is a low-income area. Because of the strike, these children are deprived of their education, breakfast, lunch and a safe place to be." -- **Sister Rene Procopio**, director of the after-school program in the Mooncrest housing development in Moon, expressing concerns about the impact of a strike by Moon Area teachers.

December

"The closer we come to opening the new library, the more excited I become." -- Councilwoman **Mary Weise**, on the planned Jan. 3 opening of the new Bridgeville Public Library.

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"This stuff about bringing up deer culling every other month is counterproductive." -- Scott Commissioner **Bill Wells**, who suggested a moratorium on deer debate for 37 months, which is the time remaining in his term.

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"We have been losing money for years." -- **The Rev. Regis Ryan**, Focus on Renewal executive director, on discontinuing participation in the ACCESS transportation program.

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"We are looking at sharing personnel, potentially. The towns we serve are close to each other. We may be able to buy and maintain fewer ambulances." -- **J.R. Henry**, executive director and chief at the Valley Ambulance Authority in Moon, explaining a feasibility study to share equipment and programs with NorthWest EMS.

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